

“OpenStack is a very ambitious project and has a lot of usability”

It's new, it's young and it definitely is the talk of the town. The OpenStack project is the hottest topic in open source circles... possibly one of the biggest projects in the recent past. The OpenStack Foundation that supports the OpenStack project is making all the right moves. On the one hand, the foundation is engaging with developers and, on the other, it's involving companies that can provide a commercial direction to the project.

Diksha P Gupta from *Open Source For You* spoke to **Jonathan Bryce**, executive director of the *OpenStack Foundation*, about the project, its latest release and its strategy.



Jonathan Bryce, executive director of the OpenStack Foundation

Q: How would you define OpenStack so that everyone—non-technical readers as well as open source enthusiasts—understands what it's all about?

OpenStack is a community of developers and organisations around the world that is building software for cloud computing. It is open source software released under the Apache License. You can take that software and build a public or a private cloud, which you can use to manage servers and networks.

Q: How is the OpenStack Foundation empowering the growth and development of OpenStack?

The OpenStack Foundation is an independent non-profit organisation that is focused on opening up our community all around the world to develop software and help people to make successful use of the software. We do that with a number of different programmes. We hold a lot of events and support many others across the globe. We

bring our developers together each year and plan our software—how to go about the next version, et al. The next event is going to be in Hong Kong in November, where we expect 4000-5000 people to attend and discuss OpenStack's growth in detail and help it grow further. We also have a number of programmes in place to help popularise the project and encourage new people to join the community, use the software and make contributions to it.

Q: If I were a developer and wanted to be a part of the project, could you explain how I could join it?

The OpenStack Foundation has about 10,000 members who have joined from over 130 countries. It is free to join the OpenStack Foundation, so anyone who wants to participate in the project can join it. You can join as an 'individual member', you can get involved in local meetups, start contributing and help with critical start-up tasks. It's free!

This is an exciting time for OpenStack, with the establishment of an independent, permanent legal home that can represent Stackers all over the globe for many years to come. As an individual member, you can:

- Get active in the OpenStack community as a user, developer, business person, art maker, or in any other way you want to contribute.
- Run for an elected position such as the project technical lead on projects you contribute to, as the technical committee member, or as a member of the Foundation's board of directors.
- Vote in elections for the board of directors.
- Stay informed on the latest OpenStack news through member updates.

Visit <https://www.openstack.org/join/> to join as an 'individual member' of the foundation. If you are a user, developer or potential tester, you can view this helpful resource about how to get started contributing to OpenStack: https://wiki.openstack.org/wiki/How_To_Contribute.

Q: A lot of heavyweights are attached to the OpenStack project. Yet, despite the presence of these major open source vendors, the OpenStack project took a lot of time to take off. Why was that? We do have quite a few major technology companies involved, as well as innovative startups emerging around the project. I actually